

Jessica Yi Fei Bo

CONTACT	Email: jessica.bo@mail.utoronto.ca jbo@cs.toronto.edu Website: https://jessica-bo.github.io/
EDUCATION	University of Toronto , Toronto, Canada <i>PhD in Computer Science</i> , expected 2027 <u>Topic:</u> Human-AI interactions. <u>Advisor:</u> Ashton Anderson (<i>Computational Social Science Lab</i>) ETH Zurich , Zurich, Switzerland <i>MSc in Mechanical Engineering (Robotics)</i> , 2023 <u>Thesis</u> at Massachusetts Institute of Technology and Harvard Medical School : “Improving Deep Learning Model Generalizability with Adversarial Augmentations for Time-Series Physiological Data” <u>Advisors:</u> Giovanni Traverso, Hen-Wei Huang (<i>Laboratory for Translational Engineering</i>) University of British Columbia , Vancouver, BC, Canada <i>BASc In Mechanical Engineering (Biomedical)</i> , 2020 <u>Thesis:</u> “Wheelchair detection and state estimation using laser scanning sensors for mobile robots” <u>Advisor:</u> Machiel Van der Loos (<i>CARIS Robotics Lab</i>)
RESEARCH EXPERIENCES	Google , Mountain View, CA, USA <i>Student Researcher for Google AR</i> Fall 2024 – Winter 2025 National University of Singapore , Singapore <i>Research Assistant in the Ubicomp Lab</i> Winter – Summer 2023 Massachusetts Institute of Technology , Cambridge, MA, USA <i>Visiting Thesis Student in the Laboratory for Translational Engineering</i> 2022 École polytechnique fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL) , Lausanne, Switzerland <i>Summer@EPFL Research Assistant in the Visual Intelligence and Learning Lab</i> Summer 2021 Attentiv Medical , Vancouver, BC, Canada <i>Co-Founder and Research Lead</i> 2020–2022 <i>Awards:</i> James Dyson National Winner (Canada) and International Top 20, Microsoft Discover AI - Healthcare Winner, Medical Device Design Center Principal Award, UBC Innovation on Board Start-Up Competition (Runner Up). Lund University , Lund, Sweden <i>Research Assistant in the CERTEC Rehabilitation Engineering Group</i> Summer 2017
CONFERENCE PAPERS	Bo J , Kazemitabaar M, Deng M, Inzlicht M, Anderson A (2025). “Invisible Saboteurs: Sycophantic LLMs Mislead Novices in Problem-Solving Tasks”. <i>To appear at CHI 2026</i> . Bo J* , Mok L*, Anderson A (2026). “Language Models Exhibit Inconsistent Biases Towards Algorithmic Agents and Human Experts”. <i>To appear at IASEAI 2026</i> . Bo J , Wan S, Anderson A (2025). “To Rely or Not to Rely? Evaluating Interventions for Appropriate Reliance on Large Language Models”. <u>Best Paper Honorable Mention</u> at CHI 2025. Bo J* , Kumar H*, Liut M, Anderson A (2024). “Disclosures & Disclaimers: Investigating the Impact of Transparency Disclosures and Reliability Disclaimers on Learner-LLM Interactions”. <i>HCOMP 2024</i> . Bo J , Hao P, Lim B (2024). “Incremental XAI: Memorable Understanding of AI with Incremental Explanations”. <i>CHI 2024</i> . Bo J , Ta K, Nishida R, Yeh G, Tsang V, Bolton M, Ranger M, Walus K (2022). “ATTENTIV: Instrumented Peripheral Catheter for the Detection of Catheter Dislodgement in IV Infiltration”. <i>IEEE EMBC 2022</i> .

	Agrawal D*, Lobsiger J*, Bo J , Kaufmann V, Armeni I (2022). "HoloLabel: Augmented Reality User-In-The-Loop Online Annotation Tool for As-Is Building Information". <i>EC3 2022</i> .
JOURNALS PAPERS	Huang HW*, Chai P*, Kerssemakers T, Imani A, Chen J, Lee S, Heim M, Bo J, Wentworth A, Fabian N, Jenkins J, Pettinary A, Ishida K, Li J, You S, Hayward AM, Traverso G (2024). "An Implantable System for Opioid Safety (iSOS)". <i>Device</i>. Vinker Y, Pajouheshgar E, Bo J, Bachmann R, Bermano AH, Cohen-Or D, Zamir A, Shamir A (2022). "CLIPasso: Semantically Aware Object Sketching". <u>Best Technical Paper</u> at <i>SIGGRAPH 2022</i>.
CONFERENCE PREPRINTS	Lee PYK*, Bo J*, Zhao Z*, Aoyagui PA*, Varona M*, Anderson A, Kuzminykh A, Chevalier F, Nobre C (2026). "Negotiating Relationships with ChatGPT: Perceptions, External Influences, and Strategies for AI Companionship". <i>In submission</i>. Bo J, Xu T, Chatterjee I, Passarella-Ward K, Kulshrestha A*, Shin D* (2025). "Steerable Chatbots: Personalizing LLMs with Preference-Based Activation Steering". <i>In submission</i>.
NON-ARCHIVAL ABSTRACTS	Bo J, Kazemitabaar M, Zhuang E, Anderson A. "Who's the Leader? Analyzing Novice Workflows in LLM-Assisted Debugging of Machine Learning Code". Paper at <i>CHI 2025 Tools-for-Thought Workshop</i>. Zhao Z*, Bo J*, Singh K (2024). "Make it Happier! Discretizing and Amplifying Happiness in Animated Faces". Poster at <i>Graphics Interfaces 2024</i>. Bo J*, Mok L*, Tie J, Anderson A (2024). "Does GPT Distrust Algorithms? Evaluating Large Language Models for Algorithm Aversion". Paper at <i>CHI 2024 HEAL Workshop</i> and <i>IC2S2 2024</i>. Bo J, Huang HW, Chan A, Traverso G (2022). "Adversarial Masking for Pretraining ECG Data Improves Downstream Model Generalizability". Paper at <i>ML4H 2022</i> and <i>TS4H at NeurIPS 2022</i> (co-located). Bo J, Van der Loos M (2020). "Detection of Wheelchairs Using Laser Scanning Sensors for Mobile Robotics". <u>Best Oral Presentation</u> at <i>UBC MURC 2020</i>.
SELECT AWARDS	Vanier Canada Graduate Scholarship (3 x 50,000 CAD), NSERC Canada, 2025 Canada Graduate Scholarship – Doctoral (<i>declined due to Vanier</i>), NSERC Canada, 2025 Massey College Junior Fellow, Massey College at the University of Toronto, 2025 Walter C. Sumner Memorial Fellowship (15,7000 CAD), Walter C. Sumner Foundation, 2024, 2025 Ontario Graduate Scholarship (3 x 5,000 CAD), Government of Ontario, 2024 Schwartz Reisman Graduate Fellow (7500 CAD), Schwartz Reisman Institute, 2024. Wolfond Scholarship in Wireless Information Technology (5000 CAD), University of Toronto, 2024 Finalist for Gates Cambridge Scholarship, Cambridge University, 2023 Graduate Research Grant (3400 USD), IEEE Computational Intelligence Society, 2022 Master Thesis Grant (10,500 CHF), Zeno Karl Schindler Foundation, 2022 Swiss-European Mobility Scholarship (4500 CHF), Swiss-European Mobility Programme, 2022 Heyning-Roelli Mobility Grant (1100 CHF), Heyning-Roelli Foundation, 2021 Women in Technology Scholarship (10,000 CAD), Irving K Barber BC Scholarship Society, 2019
ACADEMIC INVOLVEMENT	Teaching Assistant <i>Fall 2025</i> - CSC2702: Technical Entrepreneurship <i>Winter 2024</i> - CSC311: Introduction to Machine Learning <i>Fall 2023</i> - CSC148: Introduction to Computer Science Workshop Organizer <i>Graphic Interfaces 2025</i> – "The Role of AI-Empowered Machine Subjectivity in HCI Tasks" Reviewer <i>CHI 2026, CSCW 2026, CHI 2025, CHI EA 2025, IC2S2 2025</i> Student Volunteer

UIST 2024, CHI 2024, NeurIPS 2022

**VOLUNTEERING
& OUTREACH**

Massey College, University of Toronto

Junior Fellow & Printing Press Apprentice | 2025–ongoing

Computer Science Graduate Society (CSGS), University of Toronto

Graduate Affairs Committee Representative | 2023–ongoing

Graduate Application Assistance Program (GAAP), University of Toronto

Lead Organizer | 2025

Mentor for Prospective Applicants | 2023, 2024, 2025

Women in Science and Engineering, University of Toronto

Mentor for Undergraduate Students | 2024

Department of Computer Science, University of Toronto

Graduate Admissions Triager | Fall 2023

Traverso Lab Machine Learning Corner, Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Reading Group Organizer | 2022

Open Roboethics Institute, Montreal, QC, Canada (remote)

AI Fairness Toolkit & Roboethics Competitions | 2021–2023

UBC Biomedical Engineering Student Team, University of British Columbia

Research Team for Orthopedic Medical Device | 2016–2020

**INDUSTRY
EXPERIENCES**

Coursera, Toronto, ON, Canada (remote)

Software Engineering Intern | Summer 2020

Amazon, Vancouver, BC, Canada

Software Engineering Intern | Summer 2019

Blackberry QNX, Ottawa, ON, Canada

3D Vision R&D Intern | Winter 2018